

100 Days of Linux - Day 031

Title: Sorting Data with sort

Today's Goal

Learn how to arrange text alphabetically and numerically using the **sort** command.

Why This Matters

Data engineers frequently sort CSV files, reports, log entries, and lists before analyzing or processing data.

Command of the Day: sort

Syntax: `sort filename`

Common Options:

`sort -r filename` (reverse order)

`sort -n numbers.txt` (numeric sort)

`sort -u names.txt` (sort and remove duplicates)

Examples:

`sort employees.txt`

`sort -n salaries.txt`

Beginner Lesson

The **sort** command reads a file and prints its contents in order. By default it sorts alphabetically. With the **-n** option it sorts numbers correctly, and **-r** reverses the order.

Practice Questions

1. Create a file named `fruits.txt` containing 10 fruit names in random order. Display them alphabetically using `sort`.
2. Create a file named `numbers.txt` containing the numbers 45, 2, 100, 18, and 9 on separate lines. Sort them numerically.
3. Display the fruits in reverse alphabetical order.
4. Create a file named `cities.txt` with duplicate city names. Sort the file and remove duplicate entries.
5. Display your current working directory after completing today's tasks.

Hints

Use Nano to create files, then experiment with `sort`, `sort -n`, `sort -r`, and `sort -u`.

Mini Challenge

Create `employees.txt` with 10 employee names in random order and `salaries.txt` with 10 random salaries. Sort employee names alphabetically and salaries numerically.

Common Mistakes

Forgetting to use -n for numbers. Without it, 100 may appear before 9 because text is sorted alphabetically.

Did You Know?

The sort command does not modify the original file unless you redirect the output to a file.

Pro Tip

Sorting data before using other text-processing tools often makes analysis much easier.

Answer Key (Instructor Only)

Q1: sort fruits.txt

Q2: sort -n numbers.txt

Q3: sort -r fruits.txt

Q4: sort -u cities.txt

Q5: pwd

Homework

Create three files containing names, numbers, and product IDs. Practice alphabetical, reverse, numeric, and unique sorting.

Next Day Preview

Tomorrow you'll learn the uniq command to identify and remove duplicate lines from sorted files.